

Placement Simulator - Interview Report

Role: SDE
Category: dsa
Difficulty: medium

Scores

overall: 85/100
technical: 88/100
communication: 80/100
confidence: 75/100
problemSolving: 85/100
coding: 0/100

Strengths

- Accurately described binary search on rotated arrays with a clear invariant.
- Identified trade offs for kth largest element, including sorting, min heap, and complexity analysis.
- Correctly explained two stack queue implementation and amortized analysis.

Weaknesses

- Did not mention alternative $O(n)$ quickselect for kth largest when k is large.
- Invariant description was brief; could elaborate on boundary conditions.
- Answers were concise but sometimes lacked discussion of edge cases.

Suggestions

- Practice explaining edge cases (e.g., empty array, single element, duplicates) for each algorithm.
- Include quickselect as a competitive alternative for kth largest when k is not small.
- Expand invariant explanation to cover how the search range updates in each iteration.

Summary

The candidate demonstrates solid technical knowledge and clear reasoning across all questions, with strong correctness and concise communication. Minor gaps include lack of alternative algorithms for kth largest and limited discussion of edge cases. Overall performance is strong, suitable for a mid level SDE role.